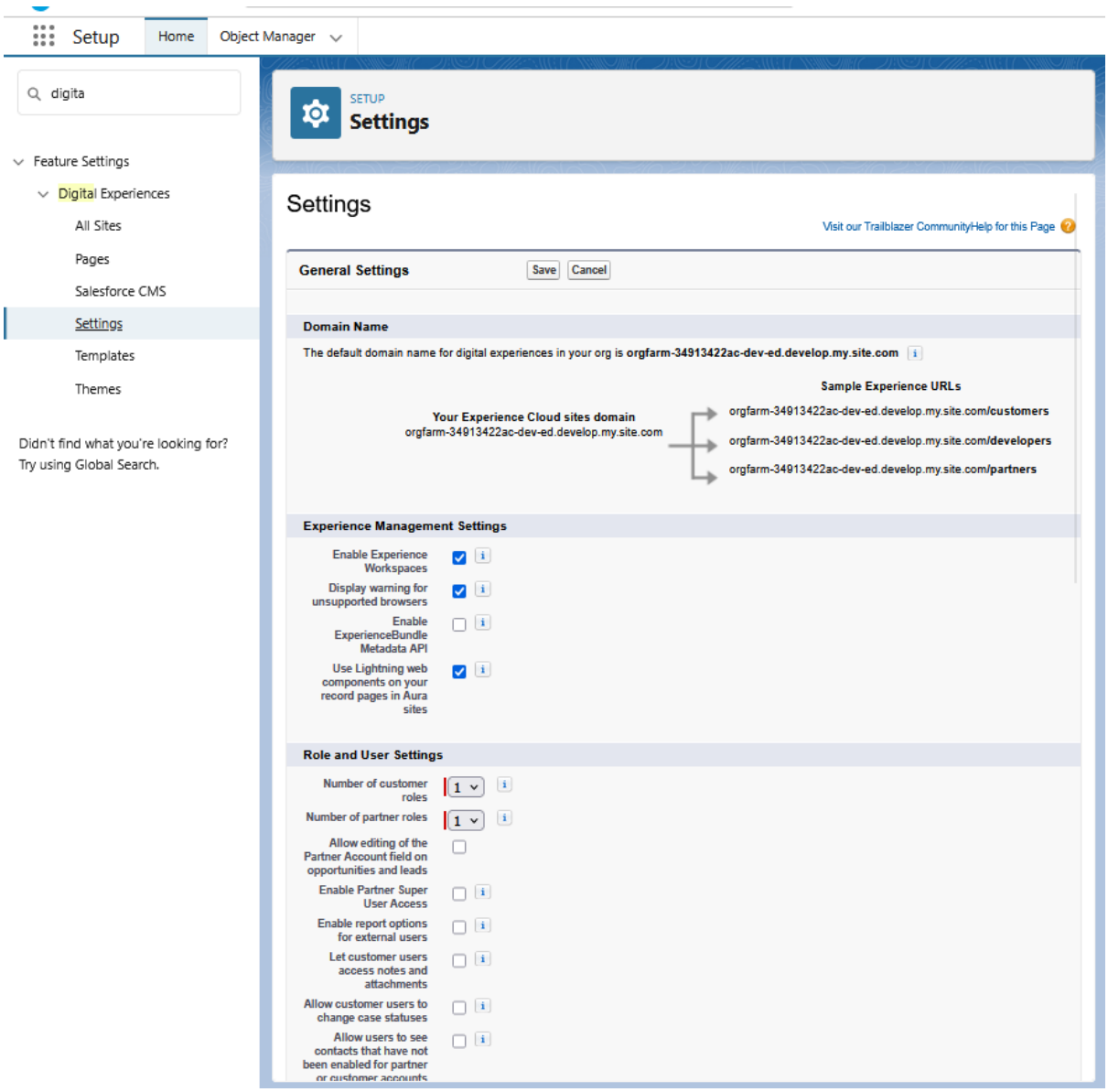
Phase 7



Experience Builder Knowledge Article Display: Theory Points

1. **Problem**
   - Standard **Experience Builder list/detail components** may **not appear** for custom objects like Knowledge Article.
   - Users need a way to **search, view, and display published articles** in the Experience site.
2. **Two Main Options**

A) Standard Object Page

- Use the **built-in Object Page** in Experience Builder (if supported).
- Steps:
  1. Ensure the object has a **Custom Tab**.
  2. Open Experience Builder → Pages → New → Object Page.
  3. Select Knowledge Article, choose **List** or **Record** layout.
  4. Configure filters and display settings.
  5. Publish the page.
- **Pros**: Fast, uses standard Salesforce UI components.
- **Cons**: Limited customization; may not show if standard components aren't supported.

B) Custom Lightning Web Component (Recommended)

- Build an **LWC** to display articles with full control over search, display, and actions.
- Steps (in theory):
  1. Create **Apex controller** with @AuraEnabled methods:
     - searchArticles(String term) → returns **Published articles**.
     - incrementViewCount(Id articleId) → increments view count on detail view.
  2. Create **LWC** that:
     - Calls Apex methods to get article data.
     - Renders **search box, list, and modal** for article details.
     - Handles **view count increment** when an article is opened.
  3. Configure **LWC meta file** to expose the component in Experience Builder (lightningCommunity__Page).
  4. Deploy Apex + LWC to Salesforce org.
  5. Drag the LWC onto Experience Builder page, configure properties, and publish.
  6. Grant **Guest User access** to Apex class and object/fields if site is public.

3. **Key Features Achieved with LWC Approach**

- **Search functionality** across title, content, and tags.
- **Dynamic listing** with sortable columns and truncated preview.
- **Detail modal** showing full content, category, and view count.
- **Automatic view count increment** on article open.
- **Guest user-safe display**: Only Published articles visible.

4. **Security Considerations**
    - Use with sharing in Apex to enforce record-level access.
    - Filter articles by Status__c = 'Published' to avoid exposing drafts.
    - Limit Guest User profile permissions to **Read-only** for object and fields.
    - Only allow Apex class execution for guest users if necessary.
5. **Advantages of Custom LWC**
    - Complete control over UI, styling, and interaction.
    - Works reliably even if standard Experience Builder components are missing.
    - Easier to add features like search debounce, modal pop-ups, or analytics (view counts).
    - Flexible for both authenticated and guest users.
6. **Best Practice Recommendation**
    - Try **Option A** (standard Object Page) first if supported.
    - Use **Option B** (custom LWC) for full control, advanced search, or guest user access.
    - Always validate Guest User permissions and test site behavior before publishing.